

Four Working Knots

ChatGPT edition

Tie, inspect, test

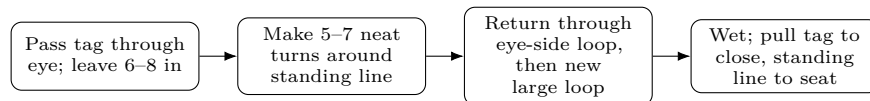
CONTROL HOOKS AND STORED ENERGY

Point hooks away from faces and hands. Wear eye protection when testing or pulling free. Cut snagged line under control; never snap it toward the boat.

Choose the knot before tying

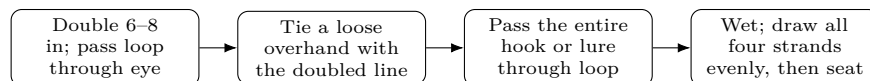
Knot	Use when	Do not choose when
Improved clinch	Small hook or lure eye; mono/fluoro; familiar general knot	Very heavy or exceptionally slippery line without testing.
Palomar	Doubled line fits through eye; high strength with few wraps	Large lure cannot pass through the loop cleanly.
Uni	Versatile terminal connection; easy to inspect and slide	Wraps cannot be kept parallel around very stiff material.
Surgeon's loop	Fast fixed end loop for loop-to-loop leaders	A compact terminal knot directly against a hook eye is required.

Improved clinch



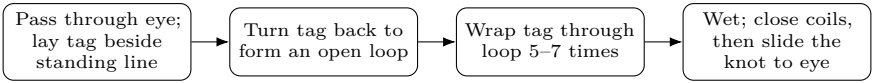
Look for: a compact barrel of parallel coils ending against the eye. **Reject if:** one wrap crosses the others, coils show white flattening, or the tag retreats during the pull test.

Palomar



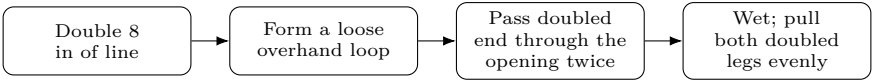
Intermediate question: Did the loop pass over the tackle without twisting around a hook point? Before seating, both strands through the eye must lie side by side, not cross.

Uni knot



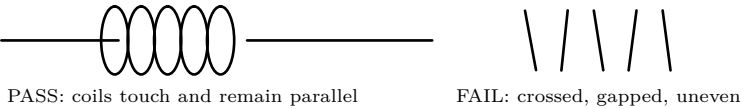
Measurement: begin with 8–10 in of tag while learning. The finished coil should be roughly one line-diameter stack per wrap, not a loose spiral.

Surgeon’s loop



Look for: two turns seated together and a loop that remains open without one leg slipping. Trim only after loading both legs.

What seating should look like



The repeatable finish

- 1. Wet the knot.
- 2. Close it slowly while guiding the coils with one finger.
- 3. Pull the standing line until the coils touch.
- 4. Pull the tag and confirm that it does not retreat.
- 5. Load the tackle connection away from face and hook path.
- 6. Inspect both sides under light.
- 7. Trim safely, leaving a short visible tag.

Failure	Correction
Knot slips	Retie with adequate tag and correct wrap count; do not “fix” by melting a tag end.
Line curls or whitens	Friction damaged it. Cut above the damaged section, wet, and seat more slowly.
Break occurs above knot	Inspect guides and line for abrasion; remove enough line to reach undamaged material.
Knot looks different each time	Use the same tag length and count wraps aloud until the sequence is automatic.

Retie now
Retie after abrasion, snags, tooth contact, a day of repeated casting, or any unexplained failure. A passing knot is compact, undamaged, motionless under a firm pull, and reproducible twice in succession.

Field proof worksheet

Time / place	One action taken	Direct observation	Pass, fail, or next action
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Close the loop
Claim: What do I now think is true?
Evidence: What did I see, feel, measure, or repeat?
Fault ruled out: What alternative explanation did I check?
Next single action: What one change will test the claim?

Final proof

Do not mark complete because every written step was attempted. Mark complete only when the guide’s observable pass condition is present, the safety chain is intact, and another person could repeat the action from this record. If the result is ambiguous, record a fail and choose one corrective action.

Source basis: Wisconsin DNR Hook, Line & Thinker.

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